Inho Choi

Department of Political Science and International Relations
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Employment

Department of Political Science and International Relations, Kyonggi University, Korea
Assistant Professor — Sep 2026 – present

Institute of International Studies at Seoul National University, Korea
Senior Researcher — Aug 2024 – Aug 2026

Department of Political Science and IR at Seoul National University, Korea
Adjunct Lecturer — Mar 2025 – Aug 2026

Department of International Relations, Bilkent University
Assistant Professor — Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

University of Southern California and Berggruen Institute
USC-Berggruen Fellow — 2022–2023

Education

Johns Hopkins University, United States
Ph.D. Political Science — Aug 26, 2022
Fields: International Relations, Political Theory
Affiliation: East Asian Studies
Dissertation: *Virtue Rules: The Evolution of the Virtue of State in East Asian International Orders*
Committee: Daniel Deudney, Sebastian Schmidt, Erin Chung, Clara Han, Youngmin Kim

Seoul National University, South Korea
Ph.D. Student, International Relations (transferred) — 2014–2015
M.A. International Relations — Feb 26, 2013
B.A. Political Science, Summa Cum Laude — Feb 25, 2011

University of British Columbia, Canada
Undergraduate Exchange Student, Department of Political Science — 2006–2007

Research Interests

East Asian International Orders, International Relations Theory, Global International Relations, Chinese Grand Strategy, International Politics of Artificial Intelligence, Diplomatic History

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Invention of the Impersonal State in Early China: A Conceptual Genealogy beyond Europe, *Review of International Studies*. — forthcoming

Historical Intersections of Climatic Change and Power Transitions: Ecological Pressure, Differential Adaptability, and the U.S.-China Power Transition in the Anthropocene, *International Relations of the Asia-Pacific*, Vol. 26, No. 3: lcag009 (with Inhwan Oh). 2026

Non-Western Interpolity Orders and Sociocultural Forces: The Shi in the Early Modern East Asian Order, *Chinese Journal of International Politics*, Vol. 18, No. 4: 496–519. 2025

Ontological Complexity of Interpolity Orders: The Encounter between Chosŏn and Tibet in Qing, *European Journal of International Relations*, Vol. 31, No. 1: 28–52 (with Minju Kwon). 2025

International Relations of Encountering the Other: Aim, Theory, and Methodology, *Korean Journal of International Politics*, Vol. 64, No. 4: 7–49 [In Korean]. 2024

Planetary Order for the Anthropocene: Republic of the Noosphere, *Korean Political Science Review*, Vol. 58, No. 4: 5–26 [In Korean]. 2024

On Being Chinese and Being Complexified: Chinese IR as a Transcultural Project, *Review of International Studies*, Vol. 49, No. 3: 471–490. 2023

International Theory of Serving the Great: 1636 Qing Invasion of Chosŏn as a Future-Passed, *Korean Journal of International Politics*, Vol. 63, No. 1: 43–86 [In Korean]. 2023

'Chinese' Hegemony from a Korean Shi Perspective: Aretocracy in the Early Modern East Asia, *International Relations of the Asia-Pacific*, Vol. 22, No. 3: 347–374. 2022

Book Chapters

Neo-Confucianism as Cosmopolitan Democracy, in Roger T. Ames and Jae Young Lee, eds., *Beyond the Nation-State: From Geopolitical Discourse to Civilizational Dialogues*, University of Hawaii Press. 2026

Presentations

"Institutionalization of Sino-Korean Tributary Relations," 16th Kyujanggak International Symposium on Korean Studies, Seoul 2023

"Neo-Confucianism as Cosmopolitan Democracy," Berggruen Institute Tianxia IV Conference, Singapore 2023

"Neo-Confucianism as Cosmopolitan Democracy," American Political Science Association 119th Annual Convention, Los Angeles 2023

"Why is There No Modern International Order: Persistence of Polycentric Space in East Asia," International Studies Association Virtual Conference 2023

"Power Shift in the Critical Zone," International Studies Association Asia-Pacific Region Conference, Tokyo 2023

"Polycentric Spatial Order and its Change," 16th International Congress for Eighteenth-Century Studies, Rome 2023

"Why is There No Modern International Order: Persistence of Polycentric Space in East Asia," British International Studies Association Annual Conference, Glasgow 2023

"Ontological Complexity of Interpolity Orders: The Encounter of Chosŏn and Tibet in Qing," International Studies Association 64th Annual Convention, Montreal 2023

"International Theory of Serving the Great: 1636 Qing Invasion of Korea as a Future-Passed," Korean Association of International Studies Annual Conference, Seoul 2022

"Recrafting Political Fiction in the Anthropocene: From Leviathan to the Eight Steps," USC Berggruen Fellows Lecture Series, Los Angeles 2022

"An East Asian Genealogy of the Modern International Order," International Studies Association 63th Annual Convention, Nashville 2022

Research Groups

US-China Relations Research Group 02/2026–present
Complex Intelligence Research Group 2025–present
Intellectual History and East Asian International Relations 07/2024–present
Working Group on the Theory and History of East Asian International Relations 08/2020–present
Monthly Seminar of Research Group on Korean Diplomatic History 09/2012–present

Research Grants

Taejae Future Strategy Institute Research Grant: Establishing Evaluation Criteria for Elected Officials (Co-Researcher) 02/2026–present

Tongil and Nanum Foundation Planning Research Grant: New Unification Vision in the Age of AI (Co-Researcher) 09/2025–present

SNU Asia Institute Grant for International Collaboration Research: Political Theory of Artificial Intelligence (PI) AY2025–present

Korean National Research Foundation Research Professor Grant (PI) AY2024–08/2026

Research Institute for Korean Studies Grant (Co-Researcher) AY2023–06/2026

Honors

Charles Lathrop Pack Award 2019
Departmental Funding for the IQMR 2017
Fulbright Graduate Study Award AY2015–2017
Seoul National University Scholarship for Foundational Research Environment AY2014–2015
Kwanjeong Educational Foundation Academic Fellowship 2011–2012

Specialized Training

Methodology

Consortium for Qualitative Research Methods, The Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR) 2017

Asian Studies and Languages

Jangseogak Classical Chinese Summer Workshop, Academy of Korean Studies, Korea 2018

Seminar on Reading Qing Documents with Professor Tobie Meyer-Fong, The Department of History at Johns Hopkins University 2017

Seminar on Translating Four Books (Classical Chinese) with Professor Youngmin Kim, The Department of Political Science at Seoul National University, Korea 2014–2015

East Asia Institute Seminar in Contemporary World Politics, Korea 2014

Seminar on Reading Four Books with Professor Il-Kyun Jeong, The Department of Sociology at Seoul National University, Korea 2012–2015

Intersession Institute for Chinese, Peking Normal University, China 2007

Pedagogy

Johns Hopkins Teaching Academy, Teaching Institute (12 workshop sessions), Certificate of Completion 2021

Languages

Korean (native); Classical Chinese; Mandarin Chinese (basic listening and speaking, medium-level reading); Japanese (basic listening, speaking, and reading)

References

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